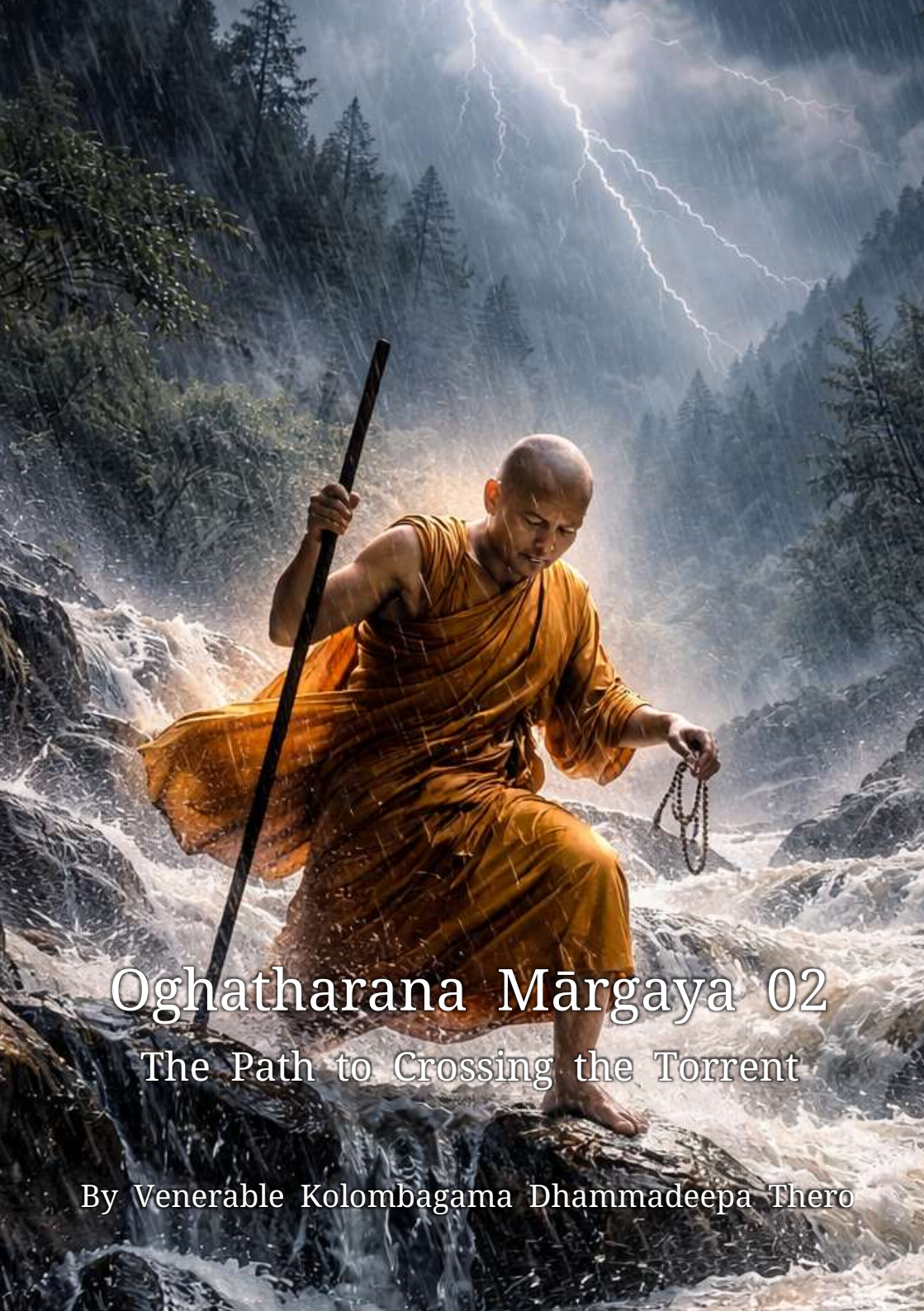

Oghatharana Mārgaya 02

The Path to Crossing the Torrent

By Venerable Kolombagama Dhammadeepa Thero

Oghatharana Mārgaya 02

The Path to Crossing the Torrent

A Gift of Dhamma,
dedicated to the faithful ones
who strive for liberation
from the suffering of Saṃsāra

By Venerable Kolombugama Dhammadeepa Thero

Other Works by the Author:

- Arriving At the Noble Eightfold Path through Anapanasati Meditation
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Sharing of Merit

May the power of merit generated by this gift of Dhamma be a causing resource for the realization of the Supreme Peace of Nibbana for our honorable teacher, Most Venerable Asgiriwalpola Sudassi Maha Thero, who guided and advised us from the very beginning to prepare this book;
for all the Kalyanamitta venerables and devotees who assisted in various ways!

Oghatharaṇa Mārgaya

The Path to Crossing the Torrent

To realize the Four Noble Truths,

↓↑

The Noble Eightfold Path must be reached

↓↑

The Seven Factors of Enlightenment must be developed

↓↑

The Five Spiritual Powers must be developed

↓↑

The Five Spiritual Faculties must be developed

↓↑

The Four Bases of Spiritual Power must be developed

↓↑

The Fourfold Right Efforts must be developed

↓↑

The Four Foundations of Mindfulness must be developed

↓↑

The necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara must be arisen

↓↑

The fear regarding Samsara must be arisen

↓↑

The phenomena of birth, old-age, sickness and death must be investigated

↓↑

Mundane Right View must be present

↓↑

Unwholesome signs and wholesome signs must be identified

↓↑

Unwholesome roots and wholesome roots must be identified

↓↑

Unwholesomeness and wholesomeness must be identified

↓↑

The True Dhamma must be listened

↓↑

Good Spiritual friends must be met

↓↑

Prior merit must be present

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- The Path to Crossing the Torrent
- Sermon No. 08
- Identifying the Roots of Wholesomeness and the Roots of Unwholesomeness

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!

I pay homage to that Fortunate One, the Worthy One, the Perfectly Self-Awakened One! May my homage be offered!

So, today is the eighth sermon of this series

Compassionate Buddhist Devotees, endowed with faith and wisdom, who are listening Dhamma through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel: you are preparing to join us today for another Dhamma sermon. Everyone is preparing today to connect with this eighth sermon we are conducting.

So, we mentioned that we hope to conduct a series of sermons for you Devotees named "Oghatharana Margaya - The Path to Crossing the Torrent"; in that series, seven sermons have been completed by now.

The entire sermon series can be summarized and presented like this:

In the previous first, second, third, fourth, fifth, sixth, and seventh sermons, Devotees, what we did was:

In the first sermon, an introduction to this sermon series.
In the second sermon, about the sequence of the sermons.
In the third and fourth sermons, two Dhamma sermons were conducted under the topic of having prior merit.
Through the fifth sermon, the matter of associating with good spiritual friends was explained.
Through the sixth sermon, listening the True Dhamma was explained.
In the seventh sermon, identifying wholesomeness and identifying unwholesomeness was explained.

In the seventh sermon, we preached to you regarding the identification of wholesomeness and unwholesomeness like this, Devotees:

Then, Devotees, if you want to identify unwholesomeness, if you want to identify wholesomeness, what do you have to do? You must look toward your own mind. Now, we asked at the very beginning, where is this unwholesomeness born? Where is this wholesomeness born? Then, the answer that must be given is: it is within your own mind that this wholesomeness is born. It is within your own mind that this unwholesomeness is born.

Therefore, Devotees, if you are to identify wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, you will have to look toward your own mind, with the intention of identifying wholesomeness and unwholesomeness.

Just like that, when looking toward one's mind with the intention of identifying wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, Devotees, if it burns your mental continuum, if it scorches it, and likewise if it is soiled, if it is impure, if it is unrestrained, if it is not tamed—along with that nature, what do we do? We identify it and mark it as 'this is unwholesomeness.'

Having identified and marked it like that, while looking at that nature again and again, you must direct the mind to that nature again and again. You must be labeling it as 'this is unwholesomeness.'

Labeling like that and directing the mind, you must establish mindfulness well in that nature associated with unwholesomeness. Then, along with the way that unwholesomeness arose, you can see it with the growing mindfulness and wisdom. We will preach those in future sermons.

Devotees, if it does not burn your mental continuum, if it does not scorch it, and likewise if it is not soiled, if it is pure, if it is restrained, if it is tamed—along with that nature, what do we do? We identify it and mark it as 'this is wholesomeness.'

Having identified and marked it like that, while looking at that nature again and again, you must direct the mind to that nature again and again. You must be labeling it as 'this is wholesomeness.'

Labeling like that and directing the mind, you must establish mindfulness well in that nature associated with wholesomeness. Then, along with the way that wholesomeness arose, you can see it with the growing mindfulness and wisdom. We will preach those in future sermons.

The entire sermon series conducted up to now can be summarized and presented in that way by now, Devotees.

Then, what we said we would preach today is about the topic 'identifying the roots of wholesomeness and identifying the roots of unwholesomeness.'

We have been hearing about wholesomeness and unwholesomeness since we were small

So, we mentioned there about the quality called **Opanayika** that exists within this Dhamma. Devotees, there is a character, a nature within this Dhamma that, by the nature of the Dhamma itself, leads one to the next and the next Dhamma nature; that nature is called the Opanayika quality.

Therefore, by now, if you properly understood the matter we said in the previous sermon—that unwholesomeness must be identified and wholesomeness must be identified—and if you made an effort to identify wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, then through the mindfulness, Stillness and wisdom that grow in the mind you directed to identify that wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, we have the

ability to understand, identify, and see within our own mental continuum the roots of unwholesomeness and the roots of wholesomeness, using the identification of wholesomeness and unwholesomeness as a condition.

So because of that, Devotees, there must have arisen within you an effort to practically identify and see within yourself those facts and matters we mentioned in the seventh sermon. It is with the thought that you are acting in such a way that we are conducting this sermon from here onwards. Then Devotees, if we once again think, reflect, and look back at the way we identified that wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, we told you Devotees that we have been hearing about this wholesomeness and unwholesomeness since we were small.

To identify wholesomeness and to identify unwholesomeness, one has to look toward one's own mind

Even though we have heard it like that, if someone asks the question "have you seen wholesomeness and unwholesomeness within yourself?", we do not have an answer to give immediately. Even if we say "yes," if a second question is asked, "how did you identify wholesomeness and unwholesomeness?", we have understood that most people do not have the ability to say "this is how I identified and saw that wholesomeness and unwholesomeness." The reason for that, Devotees, is that we have not properly made an effort to identify how to recognize wholesomeness and unwholesomeness in order, and we have not acted within that Dhamma which we identified, heard, and retained.

So Devotees, in the last sermon, we mentioned to the best of our ability how to identify wholesomeness and unwholesomeness within oneself. Devotees, to identify wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, you must know where wholesomeness and unwholesomeness arise, where they are born. Then, if someone asks, "where does this wholesomeness arise, where is wholesomeness born, where does unwholesomeness arise, where is unwholesomeness born?", you Devotees should be able to give the answer: "wholesomeness arises and is born, unwholesomeness arises and is born, within one's own mental continuum, within one's own mind." Then Devotees, to identify wholesomeness and to identify unwholesomeness, one has to look toward one's own mind.

It is in that manner that you identify unwholesomeness by looking at your mental continuum

The ability to identify wholesomeness and identify unwholesomeness is gained only if you look toward your own mind. Why? If wholesomeness arises in your mind, if unwholesomeness arises in your mind, you will have to look toward your own mind. Now, you must investigate and see, "is there a nature associated with wholesomeness or a nature associated with unwholesomeness within my mental continuum?" It is when looking like that that you can identify it.

So Devotees, I mentioned in the previous sermon that we have not developed this habit, this ability, this skill. Because from morning until night, we are looking at the world. Then, looking toward our own minds, looking toward ourselves, has been abandoned. If looking

toward oneself has been abandoned, then Devotees, you will not be able to see whether the way you think and reflect is associated with wholesomeness or associated with unwholesomeness. Therefore, in the previous sermon, we mentioned to you to look toward your own mind with everything you do and say during the day, with the intention of identifying wholesomeness and unwholesomeness.

To someone who looks toward their mind with the intention of identifying wholesomeness and unwholesomeness like that, if this mental continuum is being soiled, if it is being burnt, if it is being scorched, if it is unrestrained, and if it is not tamed—we mentioned to you Devotees in the previous sermon that "that is the nature of unwholesomeness". It is in that manner that you identify unwholesomeness by looking at your mental continuum.

To someone, if this mental continuum is not being soiled, if it is not being burnt, if it is not being scorched, if it is restrained, and if it is tamed—we mentioned to you Devotees in the previous sermon that "that is the nature of wholesomeness". It is in that manner that you identify that nature as wholesomeness by looking at your mental continuum.

Establish mindfulness while labeling "this is wholesomeness" and "this is unwholesomeness"

Afterwards, having marked it, we mentioned to you Devotees to direct the mind to that very nature that burns, scorches, soils, and makes the mental continuum impure, while labeling again and again "this is unwholesomeness," and to establish mindfulness. Likewise, if

the mental continuum is not burning, not scorching, not soiling, not impure, if the mind is well-tamed and restrained—we told you Devotees to direct the mind to that nature again and again while labeling "this is wholesomeness," and to establish mindfulness.

Then Devotees, within that very nature, to you who are seeing that nature again and again and establishing mindfulness while labeling "this is wholesomeness" and "this is unwholesomeness," from there onwards, you gain the ability to identify the next roots of wholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness that exist. It is about that, Devotees, that we are mentioning to you in today's sermon.

So, we further explained in the previous sermon that by identifying this wholesomeness and unwholesomeness in that manner, that nature associated with unwholesomeness begins to be abandoned, and the nature associated with wholesomeness begins to be identified and grow within your mind. So Devotees, we then have to know how The Fortunate Lord Buddha has mentioned these roots of wholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness within the Dhamma. To go forward from the place of identifying by directing the mind and establishing mindfulness within wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, one must know about these roots of wholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness.

<u>There are three roots of unwholesomeness, there are three roots of wholesomeness</u>

"Tīṇimāni, bhikkhave, akusalamūlāni. Katamāni tīṇi? Lōbhō akusalamūlaṃ, dōsō akusalamūlaṃ, mōhō akusalamūlaṃ."

"Monks, there are these three roots of unwholesomeness. Which three? Lōbha is a root of unwholesomeness. Dōsa is a root of unwholesomeness. Mōha is a root of unwholesomeness."

Next, The Fortunate One mentions regarding the wholesome roots in this manner:

"Tīṇimāni, bhikkhave, kusalamūlāni. Katamāni tīṇi? Alōbhō kusalamūlaṃ, adōsō kusalamūlaṃ, amōhō kusalamūlaṃ."

"Monks, there are these three roots of wholesomeness. Which three? Monks, Alōbha is a root of wholesomeness. Adōsa is a root of wholesomeness. Amōha is a root of wholesomeness."

So Devotees, Lord Buddha preaches in the Dhamma: Lōbha as a root of unwholesomeness, Dōsa as a root of unwholesomeness, and Mōha as a root of unwholesomeness. Likewise, Devotees, Buddha preaches in the Dhamma: Alōbha as a root of wholesomeness, Adōsa as a root of wholesomeness, and Amōha as a root of wholesomeness.

Devotees, even though we did not look at our mental continuum and identify this unwholesomeness, or identify wholesomeness, or identify the root of wholesomeness, or identify the root of unwholesomeness—we do not know how much we fall into suffering and distress in life because of not identifying those roots of wholesomeness, not identifying the roots of unwholesomeness, and likewise because of the non-identification of wholesomeness and unwholesomeness.

Likewise, Devotees, because of not identifying these wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, because of not identifying the roots of wholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness—not only in this life, but even from here onwards into the future, we do not understand what will happen. Therefore, if you Devotees also identified those facts and matters well, then by being established in the Dhamma, you Devotees would make more of an effort to identify wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, and to identify the roots of wholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness.

<u>That which was done through Lōbha</u>

So, The Fortunate Lord Buddha, within the Nidāna Sutta of the Devadūta Vagga in the Tika Nipāta of the Aṅguttara Nikāya, mentions regarding the unwholesome roots in this manner:

"Tīṇimāni, bhikkhave, nidānāni kammānaṃ samudayāya. Katamāni tīṇi? Lōbhō nidānaṃ kammānaṃ samudayāya, dōsō nidānaṃ kammānaṃ samudayāya, mōhō nidānaṃ kammānaṃ samudayāya."

"Monks, for the arising of Vattagami Kamma (actions that lead to the continuation of the cycle of samsara), there are these three causes. Which three? Lōbha is a cause for the arising of Kamma. Dōsa is a cause for the arising of Kamma. Mōha is a cause for the arising of Kamma."

"Yaṃ, bhikkhave, lōbhapakataṃ kammaṃ lōbhajaṃ lōbhanidānaṃ lōbhasamudayaṃ, yatthassa attabhāvō nibbattati tattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati. Yattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati tattha tassa

kammassa vipākaṃ paṭisaṃvēdēti, diṭṭhē vā dhammē upapajja vā aparē vā pariyāyē."

"Monks, whatever Kamma is done through Lōbha, born of Lōbha, having Lōbha as its reason, having Lōbha as its condition—wherever the self-state (Attabhava) of the one who did it is born, there that Kamma ripens. Wherever that Kamma ripens, there he experiences the result of that Kamma, either in this very life, or in the next self-state, or in some other subsequent existence."

<u>That which was done through Dōsa</u>

"**Yaṃ, bhikkhave, dōsapakataṃ kammaṃ dōsajaṃ dōsanidānaṃ dōsasamudayaṃ, yatthassa attabhāvō nibbattati tattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati. Yattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati tattha tassa kammassa vipākaṃ paṭisaṃvēdēti, diṭṭhē vā dhammē upapajja vā aparē vā pariyāyē.**"

"Monks, whatever Kamma is done through Dōsa, born of Dōsa, having Dōsa as its reason, having Dōsa as its condition—wherever the self-state of the one who did it is born, there that Kamma ripens. Wherever that Kamma ripens, there he experiences the result of that Kamma, either in this very life, or in the next self-state, or in some other subsequent existence."

<u>That which was done through Mōha</u>

"**Yaṃ, bhikkhave, mōhapakataṃ kammaṃ mōhajaṃ mōhanidānaṃ mōhasamudayaṃ, yatthassa attabhāvō nibbattati tattha taṃ**

kammaṃ vipaccati. Yattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati tattha tassa kammassa vipākaṃ paṭisaṃvēdēti, diṭṭhē vā dhammē upapajja vā aparē vā pariyāyē."

"Monks, whatever Kamma is done through Mōha, born of Mōha, having Mōha as its reason, having Mōha as its condition—wherever the self-state of the one who did it is born, there that Kamma ripens. Wherever that Kamma ripens, there he experiences the result of that Kamma, either in this very life, or in the next self-state, or in some other subsequent existence."

"Seyyathāpi, bhikkhave, bījāni akhaṇḍāni apūtīni avātātapahatāni sārādāni sukhasayitāni sukhēttē suparikammakatāya bhūmiyā nikkhittāni. Dēvō ca sammādhāraṃ anuppavēcchēyya. Evassu tāni, bhikkhave, bījāni vuddhiṃ viruḷhiṃ vēpullaṃ āpajjēyyuṃ."

"Evamēvaṃ khō, bhikkhave, yaṃ lōbhapakataṃ kammaṃ lōbhajaṃ lōbhanidānaṃ lōbhasamudayaṃ, yatthassa attabhāvō nibbattati tattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati. Yattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati tattha tassa kammassa vipākaṃ paṭisaṃvēdēti, diṭṭhē vā dhammē upapajja vā aparē vā pariyāyē."

"Monks, just as seeds that are unbroken, not rotten, not destroyed by sun or wind, not pithless, are well-laid in a good field, in ground that has been well-prepared by plowing and the like. And if the rain-god should drop rain showers properly again and again—monks, when it is so, those seeds would reach growth by rising upwards, reach development by taking root, and reach abundance by spreading all around."

"Monks, similarly, whatever Kamma is born of Lōbha, has Lōbha as its origin, has Lōbha as its cause, is done through Lōbha—wherever his self-state is born, it gives result in that self-state, in that five-fold aggregate. Wherever that Kamma gives result, there he experiences the result of that Kamma. It gives result in this very life, or in the next self-state, or in another self-state."

"Yaṃ dōsapakataṃ kammaṃ dōsajaṃ dōsanidānaṃ dōsasamudayaṃ, yatthassa attabhāvō nibbattati tattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati. Yattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati tattha tassa kammassa vipākaṃ paṭisaṃvēdēti, diṭṭhē vā dhammē upapajja vā aparē vā pariyāyē. Imāni khō, bhikkhave, tīṇi nidānāni kammānaṃ samudayāya."

"Monks, similarly, whatever Kamma is born of Dōsa, has Dōsa as its origin, has Dōsa as its cause, is done through Dōsa—wherever his self-state is born, it gives result in that self-state, in that five-fold aggregate. Wherever that Kamma gives result, there he experiences the result of that Kamma. It gives result in this very life, or in the next self-state, or in another self-state."

"Yaṃ mōhapakataṃ kammaṃ mōhajaṃ mōhanidānaṃ mōhasamudayaṃ, yatthassa attabhāvō nibbattati tattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati. Yattha taṃ kammaṃ vipaccati tattha tassa kammassa vipākaṃ paṭisaṃvēdēti, diṭṭhē vā dhammē upapajja vā aparē vā pariyāyē.
Imāni khō, bhikkhave, tīṇi nidānāni kammānaṃ samudayāya."

"Monks, similarly, whatever Kamma is born of Mōha, has Mōha as its origin, has Mōha as its cause, is done through Mōha—wherever his self-state is born, it gives result in that self-state, in that five-fold aggregate. Wherever that Kamma gives result, there he experiences the result of that Kamma. It gives result in this very life, or in the next self-state, or in another self-state.
Monks, these are the three causes for the arising of Kamma."

<u>That which was done through Alōbha</u>

"Tīṇimāni, bhikkhave, nidānāni kammānaṃ samudayāya. Katamāni tīṇi? Alōbhō nidānaṃ kammānaṃ samudayāya, adōsō nidānaṃ kammānaṃ samudayāya, amōhō nidānaṃ kammānaṃ samudayāya."

"Monks, for the arising of Kamma that goes toward Nibbana, there are these three causes. Which three? Alōbha itself is the reason for accumulating Kamma that goes toward Nibbana. Adōsa is the reason for accumulating Kamma that goes toward Nibbana. Amōha is the reason for accumulating Kamma that goes toward Nibbana."

"Yaṃ, bhikkhave, alōbhapakataṃ kammaṃ alōbhajaṃ alōbhanidānaṃ alōbhasamudayaṃ, lōbhē vigatē evaṃ taṃ kammaṃ pahīnaṃ hōti ucchinnamūlaṃ tālāvatthukataṃ anabhāvaṅkataṃ āyatiṃ anuppādadhammaṃ."

"Monks, whatever Kamma is done through Alōbha, born of Alōbha, having Alōbha as its origin, having Alōbha as its cause—when Lōbha has departed, thus that Kamma is abandoned. It becomes one with its roots pulled out. It becomes like a palmyra tree whose top is cut

off. it becomes one that will not occur again. It becomes one that has non-arising in the future as its nature."

<u>That which was done through Adōsa</u>

"Yaṃ, bhikkhave, adōsapakataṃ kammaṃ adōsajaṃ adōsanidānaṃ adōsasamudayaṃ, dōsē vigatē ēvaṃ taṃ kammaṃ pahīnaṃ hōti ucchinnamūlaṃ tālāvatthukataṃ anabhāvaṅkataṃ āyatiṃ anuppādadhammaṃ."

"Monks, whatever Kamma is done through Adōsa, born of Adōsa, having Adōsa as its origin, having Adōsa as its cause—when Dōsa has departed, thus that Kamma is abandoned. It becomes one with its roots pulled out. It becomes like a palmyra tree whose top is cut off. It becomes one that will not occur again. It becomes one that has non-arising in the future as its nature."

<u>That which was done through Amōha</u>

"Yaṃ, bhikkhave, amōhapakataṃ kammaṃ amōhajaṃ amōhanidānaṃ amōhasamudayaṃ, mōhē vigatē ēvaṃ taṃ kammaṃ pahīnaṃ hōti ucchinnamūlaṃ tālāvatthukataṃ anabhāvaṅkataṃ āyatiṃ anuppādadhammaṃ."

"Monks, whatever Kamma is done through Amōha, born of Amōha, having Amōha as its origin, having Amōha as its cause—when Mōha has departed, thus that Kamma is abandoned. It becomes one with its roots pulled out. It becomes like a palmyra tree whose top is cut

off. It becomes one that will not occur again. It becomes one that has non-arising in the future as its nature."

<u>It becomes like a palmyra tree whose top is cut off</u>

"Seyyathāpi, bhikkhave, bījāni akhaṇḍāni apūtīni avātātapahatāni sārādāni sukhasayitāni. Tāni purisō agginā dahēyya. Agginā dahitvā masiṃ karēyya. Masiṃ karitvā mahāvātē vā ophuṇēyya nadiyā vā sīghasōtāya pavāhēyya. Evassu tāni, bhikkhave, bījāni ucchinnamūlāni tālāvatthukatāni anabhāvaṅkatāni āyatiṃ anuppādadhammāni."

"Evamēvaṃ khō, bhikkhave, yaṃ alōbhapakataṃ kammaṃ alōbhajaṃ alōbhanidānaṃ alōbhasamudayaṃ, lōbhē vigatē ēvaṃ taṃ kammaṃ pahīnaṃ hōti ucchinnamūlaṃ tālāvatthukataṃ anabhāvaṅkataṃ āyatiṃ anuppādadhammaṃ."

"Monks, just as if there were seeds that are unbroken, not rotten, not destroyed by sun or wind, having their pith taken, well-laid; and a man were to burn those seeds with fire. Having burnt them with fire, he were to make them into ashes. Having made them into ashes, he were to blow them away in a great wind or float them away in a river with a swift current—monks, when it is so, those seeds would be ones with their roots pulled out, made like a palmyra tree whose top is cut, made into things that do not exist again, having non-arising in the future as their nature."

"Monks, similarly, whatever Kamma is done through Alōbha, born of Alōbha, having Alōbha as its origin, having Alōbha as its cause—when

Lōbha has departed, thus that Kamma is abandoned. It becomes one with its roots pulled out. It becomes like a palmyra tree whose top is cut off. It becomes one that will not occur again. It becomes one that has non-arising in the future as its nature."

"Yaṃ adōsapakataṃ kammaṃ adōsajaṃ adōsanidānaṃ adōsasamudayaṃ, dōsē vigatē ēvaṃ taṃ kammaṃ pahīnaṃ hōti ucchinnamūlaṃ tālāvatthukataṃ anabhāvaṅkataṃ āyatiṃ anuppādadhammaṃ."

"Monks, similarly, whatever Kamma is done through Adōsa, born of Adōsa, having Adōsa as its origin, having Adōsa as its cause—when Dōsa has departed, thus that Kamma is abandoned. It becomes one with its roots pulled out. It becomes like a palmyra tree whose top is cut off. It becomes one that will not occur again. It becomes one that has non-arising in the future as its nature."

"Yaṃ amōhapakataṃ kammaṃ amōhajaṃ amōhanidānaṃ amōhasamudayaṃ, mōhē vigatē ēvaṃ taṃ kammaṃ pahīnaṃ hōti ucchinnamūlaṃ tālāvatthukataṃ anabhāvaṅkataṃ āyatiṃ anuppādadhammaṃ.
Imāni khō, bhikkhave, tīṇi nidānāni kammānaṃ samudayāyā"ti.

"Monks, similarly, whatever Kamma is done through Amōha, born of Amōha, having Amōha as its origin, having Amōha as its cause—when Mōha has departed, thus that Kamma is abandoned. It becomes one with its roots pulled out. It becomes like a palmyra tree whose top is cut off. It becomes one that will not occur again. It becomes one that has non-arising in the future as its nature.

Monks, these are the three causes for the arising of Kamma."

"Lōbhajaṃ dōsajaṃ cēva mōhajaṃ cāpaviddasu,
Yaṃ tēna pakataṃ kammaṃ appaṃ vā yadi vā bahuṃ,
Idhēva taṃ vēdanīyaṃ vatthu aññaṃ na vijjati."

"Monks, these three are causes for the birth of Kamma."
"The ignorant person (does Kamma) born of Lōbha, born of Dōsa, and born of Mōha. Whatever Kamma is done by him, whether little or much, that Kamma must be experienced by him in his own self-state. There is no other object for experiencing it."

"Tasmā lōbhañca dōsañca, mōhajañcāpi viddasu;
Vijjāṃ uppādayaṃ bhikkhu, sabbā duggatiyō jahē"ti.

"Therefore, the wise person (does not do Kamma) born of Lōbha, born of Dōsa, or born of Mōha. That monk who produces the wisdom of the Arahat path abandons all miserable realms (Duggati)." (So He said.)

<u>Again, The Fortunate Lord Buddha preaches like this</u>

Devotees, on another occasion, The Fortunate Lord Buddha mentions like this before a group of monks:

"Monks, I investigate the mind of one person with my mind at this moment; if this person were to die and pass away at this moment, he would definitely go and be born in a miserable realm. Likewise, once again The Fortunate Lord Buddha addresses that same group of

monks and preaches in this manner: Devotees, monks, I investigate the mind of one man with my mind. If this man were to die and pass away at this moment, he would definitely be born in a happy realm (Sugati)."

Afterwards, Devotees, The Fortunate Lord Buddha mentions to that group of devotee monks why He happened to say that. "I said definitely this person would die and be born in a miserable realm at this moment because that person's mind is overwhelmed by unwholesomeness. Likewise, why did I say the other person would definitely die and be born in a happy realm at this moment? Because that person's mind is nourished by wholesomeness."

As if one who was brought were laid down, he would be born in hell

"Idāhaṃ bhikkhave ekaccaṃ puggalaṃ paduṭṭhacittaṃ ēvaṃ cētasā cētō paricca pajānāmi: imamhi cē ayaṃ samayē puggalō kālaṃ karēyya, yathābhataṃ nikkhittō ēvaṃ nirayē. Taṃ kissa hētu: cittaṃ hissa bhikkhave paduṭṭhaṃ. Cētōpadōsahētuca pana bhikkhave, ēvamidhēkaccē sattā kāyassa bhēdā parammaraṇā apāyaṃ duggatiṃ vinipātaṃ nirayaṃ upapajjantīti."

"Monks, I recognize the mind of a certain person in this world whose mind is very corrupted, thus delimiting it with my mind: if this person were to die at this time, he would be born in hell as if one who was brought (in the hands) were laid down. For what reason? Because his mind is very corrupted. Monks, because of the corruption of the mind as a cause, some beings in this world, after the breakup of the body

after death, are born in the state of loss (Apaya), the miserable realm (Duggati), the ruin (Vinipata), the hell (Niraya)."

As if one who was brought were laid down, he would be born in heaven

"Idhāhaṃ, bhikkhave, ekaccaṃ puggalaṃ pasannacittaṃ ēvaṃ cēpatasā cētō paricca pajānāmi – 'imamhi cē ayaṃ samayē puggalō kālaṃ karēyya, yathābhataṃ nikkhittō ēvaṃ saggē'. Taṃ kissa hētu? Cittaṃ hissa, pinketha, pasannaṃ. 'Cētōpasādahētu pana, bhikkhave, ēvamidhēkaccē sattā kāyassa bhēdā paraṃ maraṇā sugatiṃ saggaṃ lōkaṃ upapajjantī'ti."

"Monks, I recognize the mind of a certain person in this world with a confident/clear mind, thus delimiting it with my mind: if this person were to die at this time, just as something brought were laid down, so he would be one established in heaven. What is the reason for that? Monks, because his mind is clear. Monks, because of the clarity of the mind as a cause, some beings in this world after the breakup of the body after death are born in the happy realm (Sugati), the heaven world (Sagga Loka)."

The transformation of our mental continuum happens within two natures

The Fortunate Lord Buddha mentions in the Dhamma that if this person dies with a mind associated with Lōbha, Dōsa, and Mōha, at a time when the mind is kept overwhelmed by Lōbha, Dōsa, and Mōha, he will definitely be born in a miserable realm.

The Fortunate Lord Buddha mentions in the Dhamma that if this person dies with a mind associated with Alōbha, Adōsa, and Amōha, at a time when the mind exists purely with Alōbha, Adōsa, and Amōha, he will definitely be born in a happy realm.

Now look, the transformation of our mental continuum happens within two natures. One is into a nature associated with wholesomeness. Likewise, the next nature is into a nature associated with unwholesomeness. Likewise, with that nature associated with wholesomeness as the root, roots of wholesomeness arise. Likewise, with the nature associated with unwholesomeness as the root, roots of unwholesomeness arise. So, if we look at our mental continuum, we will be able to identify and see those two natures well.

So see, Devotees, it is preached that next we go to a happy realm or a miserable realm using those natures that can be identified and seen as a condition. When The Fortunate Lord Buddha properly preaches in the Dhamma that there are two such natures, to us who saw those natures arising and being born in our minds, Devotees, the trust that the corresponding realm natures also exist in that same way according to the Dhamma—faith—arises within identifying the wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, and the roots of wholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness.

Therefore, Devotees, now look, the question of whether we knew or did not know about the roots of wholesomeness or roots of unwholesomeness is not relevant, even though we did not know about this wholesomeness and unwholesomeness. These roots of

wholesomeness, roots of unwholesomeness, with a mind associated with wholesomeness, and a mind associated with unwholesomeness, create these mentioned results for us in the next moment. Because this is a law of cause and effect.

It is not a pleasant dwelling that is created at that moment

Likewise, Devotees, that is a nature that creates the next moment and the next life. But Devotees, when the mind is kept overwhelmed by roots of unwholesomeness, by a mind associated with unwholesomeness, look at the fire it creates within our mental continuum in this very life. Devotees, if you acted by being established in that previous sermon, if you investigated, you see the nature of "burning the mental continuum." Yes, unwholesomeness, the nature of unwholesomeness burns the mental continuum, it soils it, it makes it impure, it makes it unrestrained.

So look, that nature does not create a pleasant dwelling for us as a result to be experienced in this very life at that moment. It is a distress that it creates, it is a burning, a scorching, a fire that it creates. It is a pressure that it creates. It makes one reach suffering and exhaustion.

It is a pleasant dwelling that is created

Likewise, Devotees, if you investigated in the last sermon, if you identified wholesomeness, it has a nature of purifying the mind. It has a nature of restraining. It has a nature of taming. It has a calm nature. That nature creates a happiness for oneself in the present

moment within the mental continuum. It is a pleasant dwelling that is created. One feels a joy, a lightness, a consolation.

Therefore, Devotees, if you want to dwell happily in this way, if you want to dwell with ease, if you want to lead a successful life, you will have to look at your mental continuum and identify wholesomeness, unwholesomeness, roots of wholesomeness, and roots of unwholesomeness, and having labeled them, abandon from the mental continuum that nature that burns, scorches, and puts the mental continuum under pressure. Likewise, to maintain the nature associated with wholesomeness that purifies the mental continuum again and again.

It is not something that can be hidden

So Devotees, look at this matter. we have seen many people keep Lōbha in the mind and try to show that there is no Lōbha. They keep anger in the mind and try to show that there is no anger. Those people know that it is not good for others to know about this Lōbha in their mind. They know it is not good for others to know about the anger in their mind. But Devotees, it is not something that can be hidden. It cannot be hidden. But we can abandon that Lōbha within that mental continuum. Abandon Dōsa. Abandon Mōha.

Therefore, Devotees, you should be labeling in a way that Lōbha is abandoned. You should be labeling in a way that Dōsa is abandoned. Likewise, you should be labeling in a way that Mōha is abandoned. Devotees, if you label like that, then you have nothing to hide. You can act by abandoning those roots of unwholesomeness and

abandoning the natures associated with unwholesomeness within the mental continuum. You will be able to identify the natures associated with wholesomeness and maintain those natures associated with wholesomeness.

The majesty of the result has slipped away

Then these Devotees, should be aware of this wholesomeness and unwholesomeness in that manner. If we are not aware of wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, a great harm will happen to us within this life and also forward from here. Therefore, likewise Devotees, before explaining a bit more about identifying the roots of wholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness, I must say a few small things about the harms caused to us by these roots of unwholesomeness—Lōbha, Dōsa, and Mōha—being born in our minds.

I preached to you Devotees that the gain of a human life is rare. The Fortunate Lord Buddha has mentioned in the Dhamma that being born in this world as a human being is an extremely rare matter. Devotees, when we gain this human self-state in this life, the Lōbha that arose in our minds in previous Samsara has prevented us from being made into ones of great majesty.

Devotees, see how that is, I will also remind you of a small story there. You Devotees know the story of the Brahmin 'Ekasaataka'. The Brahmin Ekasaataka and the Brahmin woman Ekasaataka had only one upper garment. So, the Brahmin woman Ekasaataka would wrap herself in this garment and come near The Fortunate Lord Buddha during the daytime to hear the Dhamma. Likewise, the Brahmin

Ekasaataka would wrap himself in this garment and come near The Fortunate Lord Buddha in the evening to hear the Dhamma.

In this way, on an occasion when the Brahmin Ekasaataka had come to hear the Dhamma in the evening, with the confidence of mind developed by hearing the Dhamma, a thought arises to the Brahmin Ekasaataka: "I must offer this garment that I am wearing to The Fortunate Lord Buddha." But Devotees, along with the birth of that thought, a large number of greedy thoughts arise in opposition. "How can the Brahmin woman and I (manage) if I give this garment, as we have only this one garment? How can we come to hear the sermons if I offer this?" and so on. Devotees, after that, he abandons the mind that came to offer that garment.

Next, Devotees, he hears the Dhamma again. When hearing the Dhamma again, because of the confidence of mind arising from hearing the Dhamma of the Lord Buddha, in the second instance also, a thought arises that he must offer that garment. Along with the birth of that thought, Devotees, what does happen? To the Brahmin Ekasaataka, that mind also gets covered by those thoughts associated with Lōbha as before. In that instance also, he becomes unable to offer it. But in the third instance, Devotees, this Brahmin Ekasaataka offers this garment.

The merit of him offering this garment gives result in this very life. The king, being pleased, sent him a **Sabbacatukka**, four of everything like this: four of each—horses, four thousand coins, four women, four female servants, four male servants, four villages, and so on.

While a group of monks were talking about this in the Dhamma-hall, the Lord Buddha arrived at the Dhamma-hall, so they stopped the talk. The Lord Buddha asked, "Monks, what talk was being made before I came?" "Venerable sir, we were talking about the Sabbacatukka offering received by the Brahmin Ekasaataka," they said. Then The Fortunate Lord Buddha mentioned like this to those monks:

"Monks, if somehow this Brahmin Ekasaataka had been able to offer that garment in the first instance, he would have received sixteen of everything."

"Monks, if somehow this Brahmin Ekasaataka had been able to offer that garment in the second instance, he would have received eight of everything."

So, because he was unable to offer in the first instance, Devotees, in its result, at the time of giving result, that great majesty, receiving great benefits, was missed. The majesty of the result slipped away.

Look at what has caused us to lose our majesty

By one doing good work, it must be done at that very moment without destroying the mind that was born. The result of a wholesome deed done late will also be received late and reduced. In that way, Devotees, it was because of fulfilling a virtue such as giving, like that, that this Alōbha and faith arose in the mind and helped us also to come to this human world, Devotees. When Lōbha arises like that

at the time we also do meritorious deeds like giving, look—what does it do? It reduces that task of giving merit. It makes it small. It shortens it, Devotees. Likewise, if one is a person who provides labor, he does not give that labor completely. If one is a person who gives knowledge, he does not give the complete knowledge. We do not know why this happens like this.

The reason for that, Devotees, is the Lōbha that has arisen in our mind. Or else, because of a displeasure with some person, because of a conflict, we do not give completely the skill we know. So, look at the result of not giving like that, Devotees. Now we have received it when coming to these human worlds. Look at what has caused us to lose our majesty. Because those roots of unwholesomeness operated in our mental continuum in this manner.

If those roots of unwholesomeness did not operate in that way in our mental continuum, it is my belief that we could have received lives enriched with more lifespan, beauty, happiness, power, wisdom, wealth, and retinue. Devotees, in that way, a great harm is caused by the roots of unwholesomeness called Lōbha, Dōsa, and Mōha that are born in our mental continuum in the places we are born in this Samsara.

This much of a harm these roots of unwholesomeness—Lōbha, Dōsa, and Mōha—cause us

It is because you and I, everyone, somehow thought and reflected again and again, suppressed those roots of unwholesomeness, and acted having produced those roots of wholesomeness called Alōbha,

Adōsa, and Amōha in our minds, that we have come to this human world in this way and enjoy the five-fold benefits called lifespan, beauty, happiness, power, and wisdom. Devotees, if we had been unable to act having produced those roots of wholesomeness called Alōbha, Adōsa, and Amōha in our mental continuum in that way, by now you, I, and everyone would not be in this human world. Devotees, we would be dwelling within the four miserable realms called the Preta, animal, Asura, and hell realms.

So Devotees, The Fortunate Lord Buddha mentions in the Dhamma that this much of a harm these roots of unwholesomeness—Lōbha, Dōsa, and Mōha—cause us within this journey of Samsara. Likewise, Devotees, The Fortunate Lord Buddha mentions in the Dhamma that the roots of wholesomeness called Alōbha, Adōsa, and Amōha cause such a benefit to the being wandering in Samsara.

Therefore, Devotees, it is these roots of wholesomeness called Alōbha, Adōsa, and Amōha that must be produced more and more in our mental continuum and dwelt with. One must dwell with a mind associated with wholesomeness. But Devotees, if you investigated and looked at your mental continuum, from morning until night, until going to sleep, you are acting having produced that mentioned clinging—that is the root of unwholesomeness called Lōbha—and likewise the conflict, the root of unwholesomeness called Dōsa.

It Is Us They Are Chasing After

So, devotees, even though you desire and expect the things you like in this present life and the future while acting in that way (under

the influence of unwholesome roots), you can understand better and better as you investigate the Dhamma that those expected things will not receive within that dwelling. Look at how you have provided for the security of your life; you have built walls all around the house, employed guards, installed CCTV cameras, and established security in every way possible. Or else, you have saved some money or bought gold items to use in an emergency. Why do you do these things? For your protection—do you understand? We are not saying these things are wrong.

However, devotees, if you have not protected your mind in this way by not allowing these roots of unwholesomeness to be born, you can understand while practicing this Dhamma that you have not established this life in a secure place. Devotees, similarly, you can understand that there is no such safety, protection, or refuge in the next life or the journey of Samsara. Therefore, this identification of unwholesomeness and identification of the roots of unwholesomeness is something we should have done since we were small.

Devotees, identifying wholesomeness and identifying the roots of wholesomeness is something that should have been done since we were small. Because we did not identify unwholesomeness and the roots of unwholesomeness in our lives until now, how much unwholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness have been born again and again in our mental continuum, and how much unwholesomeness have we accumulated? Devotees, the results of these do not chase after anyone else. It is us they are chasing after. Devotees, if we look at our lives, those who know the Dhamma know

that "these things arose because of these and these reasons." Those who see, know. Similarly, devotees, because we did not identify unwholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness, we happened to dwell by producing them again and again. We did not have the ability to abandon them very quickly. Therefore, devotees, you must be skillful in this Dhamma to identify and abandon unwholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness as described, and to identify and develop wholesomeness and roots of wholesomeness.

Conflict Is One Root of Unwholesomeness

Now, devotees, having mentioned those facts in this sermon in this manner, I hope to briefly explain how to identify these roots of unwholesomeness and roots of wholesomeness, just as you identified unwholesomeness and wholesomeness.

Devotees, we then told you in this sermon that you can identify the roots of unwholesomeness using the identification of unwholesomeness as a condition. Similarly, you can identify the roots of wholesomeness using the identification of wholesomeness as a condition. Now let us see, devotees, how that happens.

Now we told these devotees to look toward your own minds. Look toward your own mind, and if the mental continuum burns like this, if it scorches, if it soils, if it makes it impure, if it makes it unrestrained—identify that nature as unwholesomeness, and having identified it as the nature of unwholesomeness, label it again and again as "this is unwholesomeness," direct the mind to that nature, and establish mindfulness.

Like that, every time unwholesomeness is born, every time it burns, scorches, soils, makes impure, and unrestrains the mental continuum, identify that nature again and again, direct the mind, and establish mindfulness. Devotees, you then gain the ability to identify the cause that is rooted in that nature of burning, scorching, soiling, and unrestraining the mental continuum.

Devotees, to you who identify in that way, at one time you can identify: "the burning, scorching, soiling, and unrestraining of this mental continuum is rooted in this conflict in my mind." Devotees, you will get to see: "it is because of this matter of conflict that this mental continuum is burned, scorched, and soiled again and again and again." Rooted in that conflict, as mindfulness is established and established, devotees, that conflict in the mind begins to become manifest within that. Devotees, conflict is indeed the root of unwholesomeness named Dōsa. Now, devotees, you who identified conflict like this as a root of unwholesomeness, label it again and again as "this is conflict," and while directing the mind to that nature, establish mindfulness.

Clinging Is the Root of Unwholesomeness Named Lōbha

Like that, every time unwholesomeness is born, every time it burns, soils, makes impure, and unrestrains the mental continuum, identify that nature again and again, direct the mind, and establish mindfulness. Devotees, you gain the ability to identify another cause, another nature, that is rooted in that nature of burning, scorching, soiling, and unrestraining the mental continuum.

Devotees, to you who identify in that way, at one time you can identify: "the burning, scorching, soiling, and unrestraining of this mental continuum is rooted in this clinging in my mind." Devotees, you will get to see: "it is because of this matter of clinging that this mental continuum is burned, scorched, and soiled again and again and again." Rooted in that clinging, as mindfulness is established and established, devotees, that clinging in the mind begins to become manifest within that. Devotees, clinging is indeed the root of unwholesomeness named Lōbha. Now, devotees, you who identified clinging like this as a root of unwholesomeness, label it again and again as "this is clinging," and while directing the mind to that nature, establish mindfulness.

Let Us See How We Identify the Matter Named Mōha

Now then, devotees, you have identified two roots of unwholesomeness. One is Dōsa. The other is Lōbha. Devotees, next let us see how we identify the matter named Mōha. Devotees, not seeing that such a nature exists within our mental continuum is Mōha. Similarly, not seeing regarding suffering is Mōha. Not seeing the cause of suffering is Mōha. Not seeing regarding the cessation of suffering is Mōha. Not seeing regarding the path that leads to the cessation of suffering is Mōha. Devotees, the very fact that you are not identifying such a process and operating within it—look, devotees, that is Mōha. Not seeing in this way is, devotees, what is called Mōha. Devotees, so then, it is that nature (of not seeing) that becomes the root for this clinging and conflict. If you identify unwholesomeness and identify the roots of unwholesomeness in this way, then within that, both these matters of clinging and conflict

will be abandoned from your own mental continuum. Then Mōha is also abandoned.

Devotees, now look, The Fortunate Lord Buddha has preached the Dhamma to remove this clinging in our minds, this conflict in our minds, and this delusion in our minds so easily. We all want to remove the anger in our minds. We all want to remove the greed in our minds. We all want to remove this the ignorance, foolishness, and delusion in our minds. But devotees, even if the want is there, without you operating in this manner, you will not be able to abandon that Lōbha from your mind. You will not be able to abandon that Dōsa from your mind. You will not be able to abandon that Mōha from your mind.

Devotees, as soon as that unwholesomeness, that unwholesome nature—meaning Lōbha—is abandoned from your mind, the burning, scorching, pressure, lack of restraint, and soiling created by that Lōbha in our mental continuum are abandoned from the mind. Similarly, devotees, as soon as Dōsa is abandoned from your mind, as soon as you identify Dōsa in that way, the pressure, lack of restraint, soiling, and the burning, scorching, and fire of the nature that made the mental continuum impure are abandoned from your mind.

Similarly, Mōha and delusion are abandoned, devotees. Within that very abandonment, if you have found a way in this Dhamma to abandon that mental state where you were clashing with, being oppressed by, and reaching exhaustion and pressure because of the matter of suffering for so long—devotees, you begin to protect your mental continuum without allowing room for the destruction and pressure of unwholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness. So,

such a mental state should arise within you now while practicing this Dhamma.

Next, Let Us See How We Identify These Roots of Wholesomeness

Next, devotees, let us see how we identify these roots of wholesomeness. Now we mentioned to you that if you find a restrained nature that does not burn, does not scorch, and does not soil this mental continuum, identify that nature well, and while labeling it as "this is wholesomeness" again and again, direct the mind to that nature and establish mindfulness.

Devotees, while you identify in that nature and establish mindfulness, you gain the ability to identify the roots of wholesomeness that have been born in your mind. Devotees, the nature of not clinging to the object. To that nature of not clinging to the object, we say, devotees, Alōbha. Why has a nature that does not burn, does not scorch, and does not soil our mind been prepared, born, and arisen now? Because of not clinging to the object. Similarly, devotees, when investigating and establishing mindfulness again and again, the matter of conflict with the object is released from the mind, and Adōsa begins to become manifest to you. Similarly, you are not deluded by the object; Mōha is also absent. Now, when you identify wholesomeness again and again and maintain and establish mindfulness, you begin to correctly understand the way and the method you think and reflect in the present moment. Within that understanding, you are not deluded. Where you identify the right thing as right and the wrong thing as wrong, there is no

delusion. Where there is no delusion, there is no clinging. There is no conflict. You gain the ability to recall and label the existing present nature.

How a Pleasant Dwelling Arises for This World and the Next

Because of the lack of mindfulness and wisdom to correctly identify and recall the nature existing in the present moment, we clash with what we see. We clash with what we hear. In this way, devotees, through the objects we take through these sense bases like hearing and seeing, we either clash or we cling. Therefore, devotees, if you are someone who looks at your own mental continuum at every moment, someone who sees, someone who investigates, then you can abandon that conflict in your mind. You can abandon the clinging. You can abandon the delusion.

Devotees, similarly, you can maintain the mind again and again associated with Alōbha, Adōsa, and Amōha. Look at how a pleasant dwelling arises for this world and the next world through practicing this Dhamma in this way.

Similarly, devotees, at any moment of a blink of an eye, you should be able to abandon an anger if it has arisen in your mind. If a conflict has arisen in your mind, abandon that conflict. If a delusion has arisen in your mind, abandon that delusion. These devotees need to understand the fact that we should develop the ability and skill to do that very rapidly by practicing this Dhamma in this way. Therefore, see, if you did not identify unwholesomeness in that way, if you did not identify wholesomeness, you cannot carry out the

matter of identifying those roots of wholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness using them as conditions. It is difficult, devotees.

This Dhamma Is to Be Seen within Oneself according to One's Own Wisdom

Therefore, you must listen well to this Dhamma in order and keep well in mind the fact that this entire sermon preached by The Fortunate Lord Buddha is to be seen within oneself according to one's own wisdom. As we see this Dhamma more and more, devotees, an easy dwelling arises for us; an uneasy dwelling does not arise within it. So, The Fortunate Lord Buddha preached this Dhamma precisely to live happily by creating this easy dwelling. To live within such an easy dwelling, it does not take a long time after reflected on this Dhamma. At the very point of reflecting, it abandons the uneasy dwelling, produces the easy dwelling, and there is the matter of living within that easy dwelling that was produced.

Those are the qualities of this Dhamma, devotees. Therefore, these devotees must be skillful to identify the roots of wholesomeness and roots of unwholesomeness that are born and arise within your mental continuum in that manner. So, in this sermon, for these devotees, by means of identifying unwholesomeness in that manner, and identifying wholesomeness, and by identifying the unwholesome roots, and identifying the wholesome roots, the explanation was provided in this way.

We Hope to Conclude This Sermon Here

Then, devotees, these devotees should look toward your own mental continuum again and again. Looking toward the mental continuum, you should label the burning, scorching, and soiling natures as "unwholesomeness". While labeling like that and establishing mindfulness, you should be skillful in identifying the corresponding root of unwholesomeness next. Similarly, you should identify wholesomeness. Along with that wholesomeness, you should identify the roots of wholesomeness that have arisen in your mind in that way. Having identified wholesomeness and identifying the roots of wholesomeness that have been born with it, you should act to maintain those roots of wholesomeness. Then, by the time this sermon ends, we have mentioned to you another step forward within this Dhamma.

That is, the root of unwholesomeness must be seen as a root of unwholesomeness. Seeing the root of unwholesomeness as a root of unwholesomeness, direct the mind to that root of unwholesomeness, and if the relevant root is Lōbha, label it as "Lōbha"; if it is Dōsa, label it as "Dōsa"; if it is Mōha, label it as "Mōha", and while directing the mind to it, establish mindfulness.

Next, you must identify wholesomeness in your mental continuum. Along with that wholesomeness, you must identify the roots of wholesomeness. Identifying those roots of wholesomeness, label those identified roots as "this is Alōbha," "this is Adōsa," "this is Amōha," and while directing the mind, you must establish

mindfulness, devotees. That is the exercise we are presenting to you through today's sermon.

So, having heard this sermon, you who have heard this sermon, listen to this Dhamma well, retain this Dhamma, and behave accordingly—mentioning that, we hope to conclude this sermon here. In the next sermon, devotees, we hope to mention bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions performed with these roots of unwholesomeness as the basis, and bodily, verbal, and mental actions performed with roots of wholesomeness as the basis.

May the Triple Gem be the refuge for all these devotees!

So, for you to move forward as a next step, you must have practiced, trained, understood, and developed those skills and abilities within yourself by having heard this Dhamma. Mentioning that in that way, may the merit of hearing this Dhamma provide the strength, courage, fortune, path, and opportunity for these devotees to take these steps forward within the Dhamma step-by-step! Wishing so, may the merit of hearing the Dhamma be a cause and a fortune for all these devotees to realize the sublime Four Noble Truths and to be comforted by the great peace of Nibbana! Wishing so, I conclude the Dhamma sermon by wishing Triple Gem be the refuge for all of you who heard the Dhamma.
May the Triple Gem be the refuge for all these devotees!

- Oghatharaṇa Mārgaya (The Path of Crossing the Torrent)
- Sermon No. 09
- Identifying Wholesome and Unwholesome Actions of Body, Speech, and Mind

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!

I pay my homage to that Fortunate One, the Worthy One, the Perfectly Self-Enlightened One! May my homage be offered!

Today marks the ninth sermon in this series

Compassionate Buddhist devotees endowed with faith and wisdom, who are listening to the Dhamma through the Oghatharaṇa Daham Sangrahaya YouTube Channel, you are preparing today to join us for another Dhamma sermon. Everyone is getting ready to connect with the ninth sermon we are conducting today.

In the Eighth Sermon, the Identification of Wholesome Roots and Identification of Unwholesome Roots was Mentioned

Devotees, by now, we have completed eight Dhamma sermons in this series titled the Oghatharaṇa Mārgaya. We have presented many facts to these Devotees through these eight sermons. We have explained how to act, how to investigate, how to behave in accordance with the Dhamma, and how to see the Dhamma within yourself based on the sermons you have heard. In the previous

sermon, we conducted the teaching on identifying unwholesome roots and identifying wholesome roots.

This Sermon Is About Identifying Unwholesome and Wholesome Actions of Body, Speech, and Mind

At the end of that sermon, we mentioned to these Devotees that, in parallel with that teaching, we would preach about identifying unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind, as well as identifying wholesome actions of body, speech, and mind. We have constantly mentioned the quality of **Opanayiko** (leading inward) in this Dhamma. One who investigates the Dhamma can see that the Dhamma possesses a nature that leads one to the next and further states of Dhamma. We remind these Devotees of this fact in this sermon, just as we did in the previous one.

So, Devotees, if you have listened to the seventh, eighth, and now this ninth sermon and have worked toward identifying wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, and identifying wholesome and unwholesome roots, you will be able to grasp the facts relevant to today's sermon very rapidly while listening to it. Afterward, through the Dhamma you grasp, you can continue to live within that Dhamma, knowing and seeing, just as you have practiced these matters thus far.

How We Identify Unwholesomeness

We have already explained how to identify unwholesomeness, wholesomeness, unwholesome roots, and wholesome roots. Devotees,

how do we identify unwholesomeness? We told these Devotees that when looking at your mental continuum, if it burns, if it scorches, if it soils, if it makes it impure, if it is unrestrained—that nature is unwholesomeness.

After encountering that nature that burns, scorches, soils, makes impure, and unrestrains your mental continuum, we told you to label it as "this is unwholesomeness" while looking at your mind. While labeling that unwholesome nature as unwholesomeness, you were told to direct the mind toward that unwholesome nature and establish mindfulness once again.

How to Identify Unwholesome Roots

We told these Devotees that when you identify the unwholesome nature, label it as unwholesomeness, direct the mind, and establish mindfulness, as that mindfulness remains established, you can identify the unwholesome root existing within that state that burns, scorches, soils, makes impure, and unrestrains the mental continuum.

Sometimes, that burning, scorching, unrestraining, and soiling nature might exist in your mental continuum because it is rooted in anger. Or it could be rooted in malice, fear, displeasure, dislike, or dissatisfaction. It could be rooted in conflict. In such instances, we told you to mark that unwholesome root as Dosa. Label it as "this is Dosa." We told you to label it as Dosa, direct the mind toward that unwholesome root, and establish mindfulness.

Similarly, if the nature that burns, scorches, soils, and makes the mental continuum impure is rooted in clinging, greed, craving, liking, or desire, we told you to mark it as Lobha. See it as the unwholesome root named Lobha. Having seen this and taking that state as an unwholesome root, we told these Devotees to label it as "this is the unwholesome root of Lobha," and establish mindfulness.

Furthermore, we said that when such a nature associated with Lobha or Dosa exists and you do not see it—that is Moha. We also said that the nature of not knowing or seeing right and wrong, good and bad, wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, is Moha. Similarly, not knowing about suffering, the cause of suffering, the cessation of suffering, and the path leading to the cessation of suffering is Moha. If one does not investigate and establish mindfulness through such a program, it means they do not know the path. They do not know about suffering or the path to escape from suffering. This is Moha. The lack of knowing how to see, the lack of identifying, the lack of recalling that an unwholesome state or unwholesome roots have been born in the mental continuum—that is what is called Moha.

Identifying that nature as Moha, recognizing that the quality of not seeing the reality of the object is Moha, you were told to direct the mind toward that unwholesome root and establish mindfulness.

By now, we have finished teaching these Devotees how to identify the unwholesome root along with the nature of unwholesomeness. Therefore, we believe that these Devotees are looking at your own minds at every possible opportunity, identifying unwholesomeness,

identifying unwholesome roots, and having labeled and recalled them, you are directing the mind and establishing mindfulness.

How We Identify Wholesomeness

So, Devotees, how do we identify wholesomeness? We told these Devotees that when looking at your mental continuum, if it does not burn, if it does not scorch, if it does not soil, if it makes it pure, if it is restrained—that nature is wholesomeness.

After encountering that nature that does not burn, does not scorch, does not soil, but makes it pure and restrained, we told you to label it as "this is wholesomeness" while looking at your mind. While labeling that wholesome nature as wholesomeness, you were told to direct the mind toward that wholesome nature and establish mindfulness once again.

How to Identify Wholesome Roots

Next, Devotees, we told you that while mindfulness is established, you should mark the nature of non-clinging within that state as Alobha. Similarly, mark the non-conflict within it as Adosa. Mark the nature of seeing and knowing that state again and again as Amoha. We have already mentioned in previous sermons how to act by marking these states and directing the mind toward Alobha, Adosa, and Amoha to establish mindfulness through identifying wholesomeness and wholesome roots.

One Must Identify the Actions of Body, Speech, and Mind that One Maintains

Now, as you act in this manner, you must identify the bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions you perform. Devotees, bodily actions are activities performed by directing the body, preceded by intention. Verbal actions are the speaking of words performed by directing speech, preceded by intention. Similarly, we call the states of thinking, reflecting, and organizing within the mind, preceded by intention, mental actions.

Devotees, these bodily, verbal, and mental actions performed with intention are divided into two parts: unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind, and wholesome actions of body, speech, and mind.

Unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind are those performed with intention alongside the unwholesome roots of Lobha, Dosa, and Moha.

Wholesome actions of body, speech, and mind are those performed with intention alongside Alobha, Adosa, and Amoha.

So, Devotees, let us now discuss further how to see unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind within yourself, and how to identify and see wholesome actions of body, speech, and mind within yourself. Let us understand how to investigate these matters.

Bodily Actions Maintained While Greed is Born in Our Mind

Devotees, by now, you have the ability to look at your mental continuum and identify "this is unwholesomeness" and "these are unwholesome roots." When identifying the unwholesome nature and establishing mindfulness in this way, these Devotees can now identify the corresponding unwholesome root as "this is Lobha," "this is Dosa," or "this is Moha."

Afterward, Devotees, having identified these unwholesome roots in our minds, we must investigate our bodily, verbal, and mental actions. Devotees, consider the bodily actions maintained while greed (Lobha) has arisen in our mind. Similarly, verbal actions maintained while greed has arisen. Also, the way of thinking, reflecting, and organizing while greed has arisen in the mind.

Bodily Actions Performed While Anger is Born in the Mind

Similarly, Devotees, just like greed, one must be able to identify bodily actions performed while anger (Dosa) has arisen in the mind. Also, verbal actions performed while anger has arisen, and mental actions performed while anger has arisen.

Bodily Actions Performed While Delusion is Born in the Mind

Devotees, just like greed and anger, one must be able to identify bodily actions performed while delusion (Moha) has arisen in the mind. Also, verbal actions performed while delusion has arisen, and mental actions performed while delusion has arisen.

Are These Bodily Actions I Maintain Good Actions?

Devotees, investigate your bodily actions for a moment. Bodily actions are the works and activities you perform from morning until night by directing the body. Now, have you ever investigated and reflected on the bodily actions you perform, looking back at how you work in your life? Have you asked, "Are these bodily actions I maintain good actions? Are these bodily actions I maintain bad actions?" Have you ever conducted such an investigation into your bodily actions?

Bodily Actions Associated with Resistance also Subside and Fade Away

Devotees, suppose anger (Dosa) arises in our mind. Look at the bodily actions we perform when we are in front of people; we do not look at them with a smiling face. We either look down or look away. We slam things down. We toss them here and there. We throw objects. If there is a file in our hand, we throw it onto the table. If there was a pen, we throw it. Now see, we must understand the bodily actions we maintain when this anger has arisen in our mind in that way.

If you investigate your mind, you are always blaming an external person for this bodily action. You think and reflect, "He is wrong; I feel this way. It should be like this. There is an injustice here. This injustice cannot happen like this." You have accepted this. But that is not it, Devotees. The reason for that coarse bodily action is nothing other than the irritation, displeasure, dislike, malice, anger, and conflict that has arisen in your mind.

Therefore, if you can release that conflict from your mind, your bodily action will not operate in that way, Devotees. Simultaneous with the abandonment of that anger in your mind, those bodily actions associated with resistance also subside and fade away.

Reducing Everything

Similarly, Devotees, even in instances where the unwholesome root of greed (Lobha) has arisen in the mind, look at the nature of your bodily actions. When this unwholesome root of greed exists in our mind, we always act to hide things, to reduce everything (for others), to accumulate everything, to increase the pile of "mine," and to make things beautiful. The bodily actions that exist are relevant to that, Devotees.

That is Moha

So, Devotees, one must be able to identify those bodily actions in that way. For all this time, you had not identified your mental state and investigated your bodily actions in that way alongside that mental state. Similarly, you had not identified and seen the bodily actions you perform rooted in greed and anger. Doing things without such identification and sight, in places where there is no such understanding—that is Moha.

Look at the Things We Think, Reflect, and Plan

Devotees, that means, what are we doing? How are these things being done? We had not identified the bodily and verbal actions happening alongside our mental state in this way. Furthermore, Devotees, look at the mental actions—the things we think, reflect, and plan—alongside the unwholesome roots of greed, anger, and delusion.

Devotees, look at what we plan and what we wish for while keeping anger in our mind. Thinking and reflecting with mental actions like "May it be so and so," "I will do this and that," "It must happen this way," we always wish for evil, badness, defeat, and destruction for others. Is this not how the mind operates, Devotees? So, Devotees, how much does this cause further burning and scorching in our mental continuum? Therefore, Devotees, you must identify your bodily, verbal, and mental actions alongside these unwholesome roots.

It Is the Hearts of These People We Hurt

Because, Devotees, if we do not identify the bodily, verbal, and mental actions we perform with these unwholesome roots—greed, anger, and delusion—then the fame, love, compassion, and loving-kindness of others that we expect in our lives will be lost to us.

Devotees, a massive amount of unwholesomeness accumulates for us. Furthermore, we must look at who we are performing these unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind against while having

such unwholesome roots. Now see, Devotees, if we are at home while keeping anger in our mind, rooted in those verbal and bodily actions, it is the hearts of the mother, father, brother, sister, wife, husband, children, and relatives whom we see every morning and evening that we hurt.

Devotees, see how those who see you frequently will identify you. How they will describe you. Those people will distance themselves from you day by day. You may have felt that distance in your life. But you might not have found the reason for it. They might not share their ideas with you. They might have reduced talking to you. Many such things can be said, Devotees.

Similarly, if those unwholesome roots—such as conflict—are in our mind, rooted in the bodily and verbal actions performed because of it, we then live in the same house without looking at one another. Now, those in the same house and same room avoid eye contact when passing. This unwholesome root has grown in our mind to the point where we avoid eye contact. This anger has grown to the point where they do not speak to each other. Not only that, it grows to the point of arguing, and even to the point of killing each other. It grows until one think of destroying their own life.

Now see, as this conflict grows more and more in our mind, look at the bodily action of avoid eye contact —it is rooted in the conflict in our mind. If we can remove that conflict, there is no need to Avert your gaze. There is no need to avoid eye contact.

Do We Have a Life Spent in Unhappiness, Sorrow, Pressure, and Exhaustion?

Devotees, so how much does the existence of these unwholesome actions in this way put us into difficulty, pressure, and exhaustion in daily life?

Next, Devotees, we maintain verbal, bodily, and mental actions while keeping anger in our mind toward teachers in a school, toward those we work with in an institution or at office, or toward neighbors at home. We continuously maintain verbal, bodily, and mental actions toward those we meet daily while keeping conflict in our minds.

Then see, Devotees, if we spend 100 years like this from morning till night without identifying these unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind, what a life we have—spent in unhappiness, sorrow, pressure, and exhaustion.

Devotees, The Fortunate Lord Buddha did not preach this Dhamma for us to act in that way. Look at it like this: if you identified the unwholesome roots and identified the unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind, you yourself would understand and see: "These are unsuitable bodily actions, these are unsuitable verbal actions, these are unsuitable mental actions."

So, Devotees, because this wisdom has not arisen in this way in this life until now, no matter how much education, intelligence, or wealth we have, how much have we lived in sorrow, weariness, unhappiness, and unease?

One Must be Able to Identify Actions of Body, Speech, and Mind

Truly, if we think and reflect, we will see how poor we are. Because if we do not have this ability, we are so poor. We are so helpless. Devotees, how unskilled are we? But we are not ready to accept this.

Devotees, as long as you do not look toward your own side in this way, you will fail to identify, mark, and see that "your bodily actions are unwholesome, your verbal actions are unwholesome, and your mental actions are unwholesome." It cannot be so now, Devotees. Now, when looking toward the mind, you must be able to identify the unwholesome roots. Having identified the unwholesome roots, you must be able to identify those bodily, verbal, and mental actions.

Having identified them, what do you do now? You must be able to establish mindfulness while labeling and directing the mind to the relevant bodily action as "this is an unwholesome bodily action," to the relevant verbal action as "this is an unwholesome verbal action," and to the mental action of thinking and reflecting as "this is an unwholesome mental action."

This Dhamma, Devotees, is a mirror. It is through a mirror that we look at our flaws every morning and evening. You get ready, go before the mirror, and search for your own flaws. Finding them, you fix them yourself. Through the Dhamma, if we do not see our flaws and identify them in this way, we will never see a correction in this life. Then, Devotees, if we do not correct ourselves in daily life, we become someone who commits many faults every day, someone who adds many new faults. In this way, Devotees, the day you take leave

of life and pass away, you will be someone who did fault day by day, who collected a pile of faults day by day, and who was unable to see flaws and correct them day by day. Devotees, you will see someday when reflecting on how you spent your life, what an unbeneficial life you have finally spent as a human being.

We Are Not Skillful in Seeing Our Own Flaws, Devotees

So on that day, Devotees, a great sorrow, regret, fear, trembling, and helplessness will arise alongside that. So, in that way, you identify unwholesome roots. Alongside those unwholesome roots, you identify bodily, verbal, and mental actions. Identifying them, you label them as "this is an unwholesome bodily, verbal, or mental action," direct the mind toward the relevant action, and establish mindfulness.

Or there is another way. Suppose you are talking to someone. While talking, you become skillful in identifying the unwholesome states in your mind: "With what kind of mind am I speaking? What is the nature of my mind? Is there anger in my mind right now? Or is there greed? Is there conceit?" Similarly, when performing a bodily action, you investigate: "Am I doing this with dislike? With displeasure? With conflict, irritation, or by keeping malice in the mind?"

In both those ways, Devotees, you will be able to see if your bodily actions are unwholesome, if your verbal actions are unwholesome, and if your mental actions are unwholesome.

For all this time in our lives, we only saw the flaws of others; we searched for and saw the flaws of the world. We are still not skillful in seeing our own flaws, Devotees. If we are to see our own flaws, we must peek and look at ourselves in this way within this Dhamma, Devotees. So, look in that order. Become someone who identifies unwholesomeness, unwholesome roots, and unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind in that way.

We Must be Skillful in Identifying Wholesome Actions of Body, Speech, and Mind

Devotees, afterward let us see—we identified wholesomeness and wholesome roots. Then, Devotees, we must be skillful in identifying wholesome actions of body, speech, and mind. Having identified them, Devotees, we must develop these bodily actions. We must develop verbal actions more and more wholesomely. We must develop mental actions more and more wholesomely.

Devotees, truly, if we stop and look for a moment, developing wholesome bodily actions, wholesome verbal actions, and wholesome mental actions is not that difficult. Devotees, it is precisely because of not investigating ourselves and those who live with us with wisdom that a virtue or wholesomeness does not grow in our mind.

Even a small thing causes a conflict in our mind because of the lack of this wisdom and mindfulness regarding ourselves and others. So, Devotees, as we mentioned the nature of wholesomeness—that it does not burn the mental continuum, it does not scorch, but it restrains and tames—alongside those states, we can identify the

wholesome roots of Alobha, Adosa, and Amoha. Once identified, we must develop wholesome actions of body, speech, and mind associated with Alobha, Adosa, and Amoha.

One Must Label and Establish Mindfulness

Now these Devotees worship your mother and father, give alms, and observe precepts. Similarly, you perform various acts of worship, service, and offerings. Look at those moments. Your mental continuum does not burn; it does not scorch. It does not soil. Then there is no conflict in the mind; there is Adosa. Similarly, there is no greed; there is Alobha. Also, there is a good conviction in Kamma and its results, and a good wisdom regarding the knowledge of this world and the next. This is Amoha. Alongside those, you must look well at your bodily actions. You must see those bodily actions. Seeing them, you must label those bodily actions as wholesome. You must label them and establish mindfulness.

Similarly, with those wholesome roots, you talk to your mother, father, and the monks. You talk to teachers. While talking, you have loving-kindness toward them, Devotees. There is no conflict. Also, it is not about deceiving them to get something from them. Devotees, the very intention in your mind is to help and support them. That is the nature of Alobha. Also, the nature of being happy by doing good for them, thinking, "these are right things, these things must be practiced, these are correct things, our life can be successful when practicing these things"—that is the wisdom there. Devotees, that is the Amoha there.

In that way, at every possible place and opportunity in your life, you must be skillful in developing wholesome bodily actions, wholesome verbal actions, and wholesome mental actions.

The Verse from the Dhammapada Says:

Manopubbaṅgamā dhammā - manoseṭṭhā manomayā
Manasā ce pasannena - bhāsati vā karoti vā
Tato naṃ sukhamanveti - chāyā'va anapāyinī

(Mental) phenomena are preceded by the mind; have the mind as their master; are made by the mind. If one speaks or acts with a pure mind, happiness follows him like a shadow that never leaves.

We must begin to perform bodily and verbal actions by always clearing the mind and protecting its pleasantness. Because those things are taken not only to this world but also to the next. They are connected to the journey of Samsara. Do we have such wisdom frequently in the places where we maintain our bodily, verbal, and mental actions? Look and see if such an intent has ever arisen in our lives until now.

The Fortunate Lord Buddha Teaches in this Dhamma to Practice in That Way

When we interact with people in daily life, consider home—whom do we interact with? Mother, father, grandmother, grandfather, children, relatives, also the wife and the husband.

While interacting with these people, I must practice and maintain my bodily actions with loving-kindness, without clashing with them. While talking to them, without creating unwholesome roots like conflict in my mind, I must always speak to them with words of loving-kindness. Do we have the wisdom and intent to act with them without causing a mistake or flaw, without hurting their hearts? Have we practiced such training for all this time? Devotees, it is precisely to practice in that way that The Fortunate Lord Buddha teaches and explains in this Dhamma. By practicing so, not an atom's weight of loss or disadvantage will come to you. Through that, Devotees, just as you receive happiness, peace, goodness, fame, and praise in this world, it becomes a reason for you to receive a happy birth in the next world as well.

You Must Investigate a Little with Wisdom

Devotees, so you must think and reflect. Just think, if you are a child, there is no way you can ever clash with your mother or father. Think if you are a child going to school and learning; there is no way you can clash with teachers in any way. But you must investigate a little with wisdom. How do you investigate?

How Much Do We Love Our Father?

If we take you as a child, look at your mother and father. See your father waking up early in the morning, getting ready, and going to the institution. Why does he go to the institution? To do his job. Look at that father doing that job since morning; when he returns in the evening, how soiled are his clothes? How soaked with sweat?

There is no proper food in his stomach. Why does he earn like this? To buy clothes for these children. Also, to send them to school. To get them medicine. To quench their hunger and thirst. Just like the children, the wife must also think and reflect on her husband in this way. Why does he work like this? To nourish her. To buy her clothes. To let her live happily and to get her medicine. She must think, "my thirst and hunger are quenched because of what this man earns."

If we think and reflect on how we are connected to one another, how much compassion and loving-kindness should be born in our hearts? If one is a child, how much compassion and loving-kindness should be born toward their father? How much great compassion and loving-kindness would be born in the heart of a wife toward her husband?

Then, the bodily actions you maintain will be different from that. Devotees, then you will wait on the path for the husband who comes home exhausted and oppressed from work and serve him a glass of water. When the father who comes home so tired arrives, you go to the door, go to the gate, and welcome him with a smiling face. You wait for him to come. See, do children do this today? Children do not know how much their mother and father suffer because of them.

So, Devotees, why can't we change those bodily actions like that? When our bodily actions change like that, the weariness, pressure, fatigue, sorrow, hunger, and thirst of the father coming home exhausted from work all subside. We only need to change our bodily actions slightly.

We Finish Spending Our Lives with That Defect

Devotees, when we produce compassion and loving-kindness in our minds and change those bodily actions in that way, see how much we improve and correct our bodily actions in life. If we do not correct our bodily actions in this way, we finish spending our lives with that defect. Along with that, Devotees, if you investigate why much of the love, kindness, and compassion you expect externally has been lost to you, it is because of the bodily, verbal, and mental actions you maintained with those unwholesome roots in your mind. For that, Devotees, no one else is to blame. It is you. It is you, not the external person.

How Much Do We Love Our Teachers?

Let a child think about a teacher. How much does the teacher teach us with love, kindness, and hard work after going to school? Is it not upon that teacher that it is decided whether we become a doctor, an engineer, or a teacher in our life? Isn't it so? It is this teacher who shapes our entire future. If a child investigated the services provided by the teacher with wisdom in this way, such a child could not shout in front of teachers, Devotees. They could not be disobedient or stubborn. They could not remain without listening to what is said. They could not exhaust the teachers. To learn without hurting the teacher's heart, one must have thought and reflected in that way.

We lack this investigation with wisdom. Because we lack this investigation with wisdom, compassion is not born in our hearts.

Loving-kindness is not born. Alobha is not born. Similarly, Amoha is not born, Devotees. Without those being born, our bodily actions do not become wholesome. Verbal actions do not become wholesome. Mental actions do not become wholesome.

How Much Do We Love Our Mother?

Next, Devotees, just think about a mother. See, who wakes up before everyone else in the house? It is the mother who wakes up. Why does this mother wake up? The mother woke up early in the morning thinking, "I must prepare a meal before my children, my husband, my mother and father and my grandmother and grandfather who went to sleep wake up." That mother woke up early to fill their hunger. She woke up early thinking, "I must prepare the rice and tea before they go to school or to work." See, Devotees, no matter what illnesses or difficulties she has, without leaving us hungry for even one day, how this mother wakes up early throughout her life, goes to the stove, and keeps the pot of rice on the fire. Why can't we see these things? Why don't these appear to our eyes?

Can't we think about who she does these for? While thinking and reflecting like this, see that it is the mother who goes to sleep last at night. After clearing and washing all the pots and plates, preparing for the next day. Can't we think of these things? If one thinks like this—that she washes our clothes, sweeps the house, cleans the garden, and brings food and drink to the house—a husband can never produce an unwholesome thought toward his wife and maintain unwholesome actions of body, speech, or mind, Devotees.

A mother can never clash with her daughter or daughter-in-law, Devotees. A child can never clash with their mother, Devotees. Relatives cannot clash with relatives, Devotees. Similarly, if one is a head of an institution, he or she cannot clash with employees, Devotees. Problems arise. Without keeping conflict in the mind, by talking openly and performing bodily, verbal, and mental actions wholesomely, we can correct the problem and move forward in our lives, Devotees.

Whose Fault is it That These Conflicts Arise?

If we understand this Dhamma as the Lord Buddha preached and maintain bodily, verbal, and mental actions wholesomely with wholesome roots, there are no conflicts in this world, Devotees. There are no conflicts in families. No conflicts in the village. No conflicts in institutions. No conflicts in the world. There is no way for conflicts to arise anywhere, Devotees.

So, whose fault is it that these conflicts arise? It is one's own fault. What is the fault? These conflicts are created because unwholesome roots are born in one's mind, and being unable to see those unwholesome roots, one performs bodily, verbal, and mental actions. Through the creation of these conflicts, we fall into sorrow, pressure, and exhaustion in this very life. Furthermore, for the next life, Devotees, this is how we prepare the journey to the four hells.

The Second Kokalika Sutta

One unwholesome word toward virtuous and good people is enough. Devotees, I am reminded of a small story at this moment; I must tell that story. The Dutiya Kokalika Sutta that is found in the Sagatha Vagga of the Samyutta Nikaya, Devotees.

At that time, the monk Kokalika approached The Fortunate Lord Buddha. Having approached and worshipped The Fortunate Lord Buddha, he sat to one side. Sitting to one side, the monk Kokalika said this to The Fortunate Lord Buddha: "Venerable Sir, Sariputta and Moggallana have evil desires. They are under the sway of evil desires."

When this was said, The Fortunate Lord Buddha said this to the monk Kokalika: "Kokalika, do not say so. Kokalika, do not say so. Kokalika, inspire faith in your mind toward Sariputta and Moggallana. Sariputta and Moggallana are amiable."

For the second time, the monk Kokalika said this to The Fortunate Lord Buddha: "Venerable Sir, The Fortunate Lord Buddha indeed has words that should be believed by me. The Lord Buddha has words that should be trusted. Even so, Sariputta and Moggallana have evil desires. They have gone under the sway of evil desires."

For the second time, The Fortunate Lord Buddha said this to the monk Kokalika: "Kokalika, do not say so. Kokalika, do not say so. Kokalika, inspire faith in your mind toward Sariputta and Moggallana. Sariputta and Moggallana are amiable."

For the third time, the monk Kokalika said this to The Fortunate Lord Buddha: "Venerable Sir, The Fortunate Lord Buddha indeed has words that should be believed by me. The Lord Buddha has words that should be trusted. Even so, Sariputta and Moggallana have evil desires. They have gone under the sway of evil desires."

For the third time, The Fortunate Lord Buddha said this to the monk Kokalika: "Kokalika, do not say so. Kokalika, do not say so. Kokalika, c your mind toward Sariputta and Moggallana. Sariputta and Moggallana are amiable."

Then, the monk Kokalika rose from his seat, worshipped The Fortunate Lord Buddha, circumambulated Him, and left. Not long after he had left, the monk Kokalika's entire body became covered with boils the size of mustard seeds. From the size of mustard seeds, they became the size of mung beans. From mung beans to the size of chickpeas. From chickpeas to jujube seeds. From jujube seeds to jujube fruits. From jujube fruits to the size of gooseberries. From gooseberries to the size of unripe wood-apples. From unripe wood-apples to the size of ripe wood-apples. Having reached the size of wood-apples, they burst. Pus and blood flowed out. Then, the monk Kokalika died from that very disease. Having died, because he held malice in his mind toward Sariputta and Moggallana, the monk Kokalika was born in the Paduma hell.

Then, Sahampati Brahma, of beautiful complexion, when the first watch of the night had passed, illuminating the entire Jeta's Grove, approached The Fortunate Lord Buddha. Having approached, he

worshipped The Fortunate Lord Buddha and stood to one side. Standing to one side, Sahampati Brahma addressed this to The Fortunate Lord Buddha: "Venerable Sir, the bhikkhu Kokalika has passed away. Venerable Sir, having passed away, the bhikkhu Kokalika, having harbored malice in his heart toward Sariputta and Moggallana, has been reborn in the Paduma-niraya." Sahampati Brahma said this. Having said this, he worshipped The Fortunate Lord Buddha, circumambulated Him, and vanished right there.

Then, The Fortunate Lord Buddha, with the passing of that night, addressed the bhikkhus: "Bhikkhus, this night, Sahampati Brahma of beautiful complexion, when the first watch of the night had passed, illuminating the entire Jeta's Grove, approached me. Having approached, he worshipped me and stood to one side. Bhikkhus, standing to one side, Sahampati Brahma said this to me: 'Venerable Sir, the bhikkhu Kokalika has passed away. Venerable Sir, having passed away, the bhikkhu Kokalika, having harbored malice in his heart toward Sariputta and Moggallana, has been reborn in the Paduma-niraya.' Bhikkhus, Sahampati Brahma said this. Having said this, he worshipped me, circumambulated me, and vanished right there."

When this was said, a certain bhikkhu addressed this to The Fortunate Lord Buddha: "Venerable Sir, how long is the life-span in Paduma-niraya?" "Bhikkhus, the life-span in Paduma-niraya is indeed long. It is not easy to count it as so many years, or so many hundreds of years, or so many thousands of years, or so many hundreds of thousands of years." "Venerable Sir, is it possible to give a simile?" "It is possible, bhikkhu," The Fortunate Lord Buddha said.

"Bhikkhu, suppose there was a Kosalan cartload of twenty khāris of sesame seeds, and a man, at the end of every hundred years, were to take out a single sesame seed. Bhikkhu, that Kosalan cartload of twenty khāris of sesame seeds would, by this effort, be exhausted and come to an end sooner (than the life-span of the niraya). But the life-span of one Abbuda-niraya would not yet have ended. Bhikkhu, as twenty Abbuda-nirayas are, such is one Nirabbuda-niraya. Bhikkhu, as twenty Nirabbuda-nirayas are, such is one Ababa-niraya. Bhikkhu, as twenty Ababa-nirayas are, such is one Atata-niraya. Bhikkhu, as twenty Atata-nirayas are, such is one Ahaha-niraya. Bhikkhu, as twenty Ahaha-nirayas are, such is one Kumuda-niraya. Bhikkhu, as twenty Kumuda-nirayas are, such is one Sogandhika-niraya. Bhikkhu, as twenty Sogandhika-nirayas are, such is one Uppala-niraya. Bhikkhu, as twenty Uppala-nirayas are, such is one Pundarika-niraya. Bhikkhu, as twenty Pundarika-nirayas are, such is one Paduma-niraya. Bhikkhu, the bhikkhu Kokalika, having harbored malice in his heart toward Sariputta and Moggallana, has been reborn in that Paduma-niraya." The Fortunate Lord Buddha declared this. The Sugata, the Teacher, having declared this, spoke further:

"When a fool is born, an axe is born within his mouth, with which he cuts himself while speaking ill. He who praises the one who deserves blame, or blames the one who deserves praise, accumulates sin with his mouth. Because of that sin, he finds no happiness.

In gambling, the loss of wealth is a very small offense, even if one loses everything including oneself. But to harbor a corrupted mind toward the Noble Ones is a much greater offense.

The person who reviles the Ariyas, having established a base of low words and mind, reaches a niraya where the life-span is a hundred thousand Nirabbudas, plus thirty-six, and five Abbudas."

The Result of Immediately Effective Kamma in This Life

Now look, Devotees, at this moment, the bhikkhu named Kokalika comes before The Fortunate Lord Buddha and mentions this to The Fortunate Lord Buddha. He says both Sariputta and Moggallana are immoral. After that, look Devotees, for the first and second time, The Fortunate Lord Buddha says out of compassion, "Kokalika, do not say that. Do not say that," He teaches. At the third time, regarding Sariputta and Moggallana Theros, he mentions they are immoral in the same way. At the third time, The Fortunate Lord Buddha becomes silent.

Look, because of the karma he made based on those unwholesome verbal actions, as a result, he had to be born in hell in the second life. This is the result of immediately effective kamma in this life; it manifested as a result, and all over his body, boils the size of mustard seeds, then mung beans, then chickpeas, then jujube seeds, then jujube fruits, then gooseberries, then unripe wood-apple, and then wood-apple fruits appeared. Thereafter, those the size of wood-apples burst. Pus and blood flowed out. Then, the bhikkhu Kokalika passed away from that very illness. Look Devotees, how the consequence manifested as a result in this life.

So, Devotees, we do not know that our mothers, fathers, and others act with such compassion and loving-kindness toward us as virtuous and disciplined people. Devotees, therefore, it is not good to speak ill of these people. Sin is committed. Its result follows us in this world and the next.

Devotees, look at the story of Ambapali because of making a mistake with words. So, making a mistake with even one word is not easy. Once said, it cannot be taken back. Devotees, it becomes a cause to be born in hell. Also, it becomes a cause to suffer results for a long time. Also, Devotees, it becomes a cause to be scolded and blamed wherever one goes.

In the same way, because of a mistake in bodily action. I mentioned earlier, being in the same house, one walks avoiding eye contact, or walks averting their gaze. In this society, the people we see with squinted eyes or with a distorted gaze are suffering the results of those things. Various eye diseases at a young age occur because of looking at others, or looking at virtuous and disciplined people, with a mistaken and unwholesome mind.

What is the reason for that? By constantly not looking with pleasant eyes, but looking away in displeasure, avoiding eye contact, or glaring—as a result of that, when coming to a human world or somewhere in an animal world, the eyes become squinted or distorted gaze. So, we do not know how the results of these bodily actions we perform come to us as consequences in the next place. Therefore, Devotees, one must be very careful about the bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions that occur when these unwholesome

roots arise in our lives and we proceed without seeing those unwholesome roots.

Being Reborn in the Deva World as Mattakundali Devaputta

In the same way, Devotees, let us also examine according to the bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions performed based on wholesome roots. I will tell another small story for that; in the story of Mattakundali, he never went to Jethavanarama to hear Dhamma from the Buddha. He did not give alms, Devotees. He did not keep precepts. Devotees, at the moment of death, behold, The Fortunate Lord Buddha sees that today this Mattakundali will pass away. When looking at Mattakundali, there was no merit he had made, Devotees, to recall at the moment of death. There was no bodily action, verbal action, or mental action to recall at the moment of death. However, he was someone who had the merit to see Nibbana in this Buddha Sasana. The Fortunate Lord Buddha, surrounded by other bhikkhus, walks on alms round to the front of Mattakundali's house. Devotees, behold, as the Lord Buddha was coming, Mattakundali was turned toward the wall.

At this moment, The Fortunate Lord Buddha resolves to emit the six-colored Buddha-rays from His body: blue, yellow, red, white, orange, and brilliant. Behold, after resolving to emit those Buddha-rays, those Buddha-rays spread and reached the wall Mattakundali was facing, where they could be seen. When seeing that, Mattakundali, while looking to see where these rays were coming from, turns and sees The Fortunate Lord Buddha arrived in front of his house surrounded by the Maha Sangha. Mattakundali thinks,

reflects, "For so long I did not do a wholesome deed. I did not hear Dhamma, I did not give alms. Now I have no ability to do so, nor anything to give. I will put these two hands together and worship The Fortunate Lord Buddha and the Maha Sangha," and with a settled mind, he puts his two hands together and worships.

In a short while, he passes away. Devotees, he goes and is born in the deva world as Mattakundali Devaputta. Look, because of the bodily action done with a wholesome mind by raising those two hands once to worship, he was born in the deva world. He then comes, hears Dhamma, and becomes a Stream-winner. Devotees, therefore, such are the results and benefits for these wholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions.

Devotees, if you think about these things, reflect on them, and recognize them within your life, you will never maintain unwholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, or mental actions. You will maintain wholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions only. Also, Devotees, if you understand this practice for one week, and become skilled in correcting those bodily actions of yours, on the very first day you start practicing, there are results within this Dhamma based on that bodily action, verbal action, and mental action.

Devotees, if you expect this change from your home, it will be received from there. If you expect it from the institution, the country, the world, or society—that love, compassion, loving-kindness, praise, and leadership—all these things, from the very first moment you start to change, will be received as immediately

effective kamma in this life itself. Not only that, while a great ease arises within you physically and mentally, a great skill and wholesomeness will arise within you.

Also, Devotees, as you continue to act like this, you will have taken another step forward on the path to Nibbana. Therefore, Devotees, understand well those facts mentioned in today's sermon. Now, we have taught how to recognize the unwholesomeness, how to recognize unwholesome roots, and how to recognize unwholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions. We have taught these devotees how to recognize the wholesomeness, how to recognize wholesome roots, and how to recognize wholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions alongside those wholesome roots.

Continue Practicing Like That

So now, we expect that you who have listened to this Dhamma will, as much as possible, not leave room for the unwholesome or unwholesome roots, not leave room in your life for unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions, but will leave room for the wholesome and wholesome roots, and maintain wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions.

Then, when you maintain such wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions, saying "this is a wholesome bodily action," you direct the mind to the wholesome bodily action and, while maintaining mindfulness, continue that bodily action. Saying "this is a wholesome verbal action," you direct the mind to the wholesome verbal action

and, while maintaining mindfulness, continue that verbal action. Saying "this is a wholesome mental action," you direct the mind to the wholesome mental action and, while maintaining mindfulness, continue that mental action.

Understanding these things in this way, you continue to maintain them. Continue practicing like that. Therefore, Devotees, you might have grasped and understood those facts from today's sermon; having understood and grasped them in that way, we think and reflect that the desire will arise within you to guard your own mind, generate wholesome roots, and continue wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions.

So, mentioning these things in this way, we conclude this sermon here. In the next sermon, we have to mention—now we have talked about the unwholesomeness and the wholesomeness. We talked about unwholesome roots and wholesome roots. Right where we talked about those unwholesome and wholesome roots, as a further step, we talked about unwholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, mental actions, and wholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, mental actions.

May the Triple Gem be the refuge for all these Devotees!

Now, in the next sermon, what we have to talk about with these devotees is the recognition of unwholesome signs and the recognition of wholesome signs. That sermon will be a very long one for us. There, we will have to mention many facts within this Dhamma. Therefore, having understood these facts and practiced them, taking another

step forward in that sermon series and—I wish you may receive the ability, strength, courage, and fortune! The opportunity! to practicing and training in the Dhamma more deeply through the merit of listening to this Dhamma! May the merit of listening to this Dhamma lead to the understanding of the suffering, its origin, its cessation, and the path—the sublime Four Noble Truths—and to the peace of the Great Immortal Nibbana! and thus conclude the Dhamma sermon.

May the Triple Gem be the refuge for all these Devotees!

Glossary

Khāri - "An ancient unit of measurement used for grain or seeds, roughly equivalent to a large basket or cartload"

Dukkhassa bhikkhave, ariyasaccassa ananubodhā appaṭivedhā evamidaṃ dīghamaddhānaṃ sandhāvitaṃ saṃsaritaṃ mamañceva tumhākañca. Dukkhasamudayassa bhikkhave, ariyasaccassa ananubodhā appaṭivedhā evamidaṃ dīghamaddhānaṃ sandhāvitaṃ saṃsaritaṃ mamañceva tumhākañca. Dukkhanirodhassa bhikkhave, ariyasaccassa ananubodhā appaṭivedhā evamidaṃ dīghamaddhānaṃ sandhāvitaṃ saṃsaritaṃ mamañceva tumhākañca. Dukkhanirodhagāminiyā paṭipadāya bhikkhave, ariyasaccassa ananubodhā appaṭivedhā evamidaṃ dīghamaddhānaṃ sandhāvitaṃ saṃsaritaṃ mamañceva tumhākañca.

Monks, due to not awakening to and not penetrating the Noble Truth of Suffering, thus has this long time been run through and wandered by me and by you. Monks, due to not awakening to and not penetrating the Noble Truth of the Origin of Suffering, thus has this long time been run through and wandered by me and by you. Monks, due to not awakening to and not penetrating the Noble Truth of the Cessation of Suffering, thus has this long time been run through and wandered by me and by you. Monks, due to not awakening to and not penetrating the Noble Truth of the Path Leading to the Cessation of Suffering, thus has this long time been run through and wandered by me and by you.

Mahāparinibbāna Sutta, Dīgha Nikāya